

Winding Tree

#HackTravel Lisbon 2019 Recap

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A second edition of our #HackTravel hackathon is now sadly over. It was a great event in a great city of Lisbon, Portugal with a great and diverse group of people. Thanks for coming, everyone, you made it pretty special!

WindingTree #HackTravel Lisbon 2019



We had an amazing time with both business and technical hackers. However, in this article, I will not go over the business hacks ([check them on our GitHub](#)) and only focus on 7 submissions that we got for the technical part of the event.

Also, let me apologize here for any unfinished business, inconsistencies, or just broken things you encountered in Winding Tree codebase. We are experimenting a lot and not everything can be up to date at all times. Since we now have a much clearer direction, things will get better, I promise.

Some of the submitted projects are tremendous inspiration and we want to keep them alive.

Disclaimer: I was part of the judging process, but the order of the projects is totally unrelated to the hackathon results.

. . .

Loyalty Exchange

The team from [IBS](#) worked on an idea that's quite obvious — [using LIF as a common loyalty](#) token shared across the whole travel industry. They experimented with some smart contracts and came up with a few UX mockups.

While sounding great on paper (at least to me), this idea probably does not work in real life that well. From my (limited) understanding of the actual business, it's not how for example airlines imagine their loyalty programs. Even if they are part of the same alliance, they keep more than one and there does not seem to be a solid incentive to mix-up the current system.

Pirate-tree

[Holiday Pirates](#) brought up a team that initially wanted to work with [NFTs](#) and ended up with an interesting problem of [bookings with a shared](#)

payment. The idea is that a single person makes a booking that can be paid for by a group of people via a smart contract. When everybody pays up, everything gets settled and the hotel gets all of the funds.

The team had a great fun learning all the new technologies and used an app in Go as the client. Interesting choice, and I like it! Unfortunately they ran out of time and the smart contract (arguably the most interesting bit) was not finished on time.

This is yet another example of a specific part of travel industry where blockchain might fit very well.

Winding Road

We also got a great team from Roadmap that initially struggled to find the right project. However, their submission of an ancillary extension of Winding Tree resonated at least as an idea even if haven't seen an actual demo.

Getting ancillary providers on the platform next to hotels, airlines or OTAs is a fantastic idea that we should pursue further at Winding Tree.

Visit Abu Dhabi

The Etihad team presented a simple to use frontend web-based application controlled by voice. It used the IBM Watson API for text to speech and its aim was to offer layover packages. The guys used their already existing APIs with flights and hotels which they distributed via Winding Tree's new ORG.ID structure for any user of the platform to use.

Even as this particular project works solely with Etihad APIs, it demonstrates how it is possible to integrate multiple already existing APIs published on Winding Tree.

Verified Winding Tree Voice Assistant

Our good old friends from Siesta Cloud showed up with a mysterious egg from Google and integrated Winding Tree hotels into a voice assistant. They wanted to go the full circle and perform a booking in their existing hotel backend of a Guest House in Lisbon they were staying in. Cool, right?

The other part they were working on was a proof of concept trust clue of signing Booking requests with a private key associated with a certificate used publicly on the web.

In the end, it almost worked and the demo with Google Assistant was just hilarious. I personally liked the mashup of so many existing technologies into a single product.

Trust Clue Validation API

This team tackled our trust clues head on. They decided to create an API in Python working with a couple of them (DNS challenge and a P2P trust network) and created a kick-ass visualization of the P2P trust network backed by a smart contract.

We will surely take an inspiration from and maybe even use the full spec of the DNS challenge to make it an official and working trust clue. The approach for a P2P building of trust by declaring the relationship in a smart contract is slightly different than our idea of signed relationship guarantees, but might possibly be a more feasible one.

We also had a brief discussion on trust propagation and how to combine multiple trust clues into a single ORG.ID score. Great work on top of our idea!

Organization Portal/Explorer

We weren't able to create an ORG.ID explorer on time for the hackathon. So this team took up such challenge and delivered! We now have a vue.js

application capable of browsing ORG.IDs, checking their LIF balance and even creating new ORG.IDs.

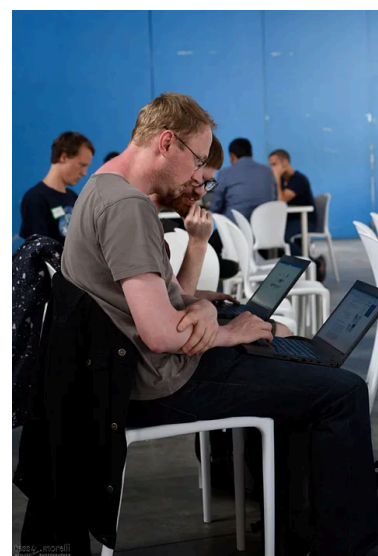
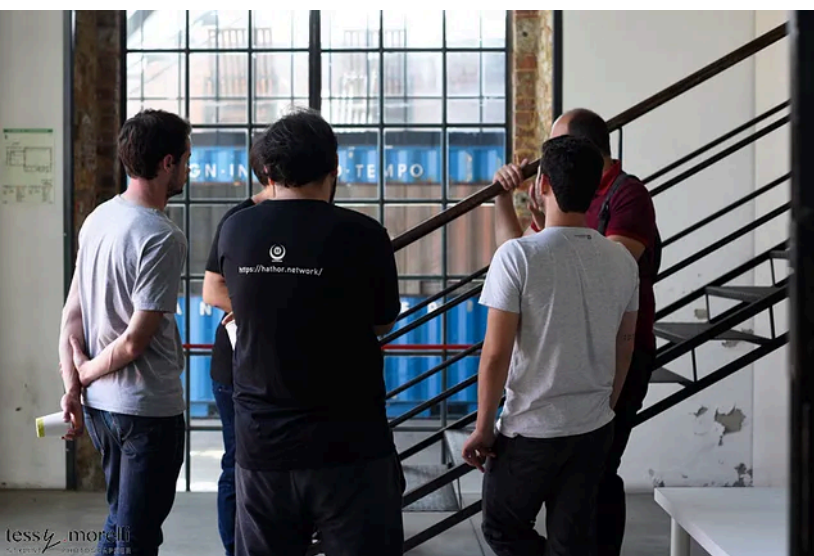
The frontend is using a small Django API that works as a cache between the frontend and Ethereum blockchain. It is *also* using the Trust Clues API from another hack.

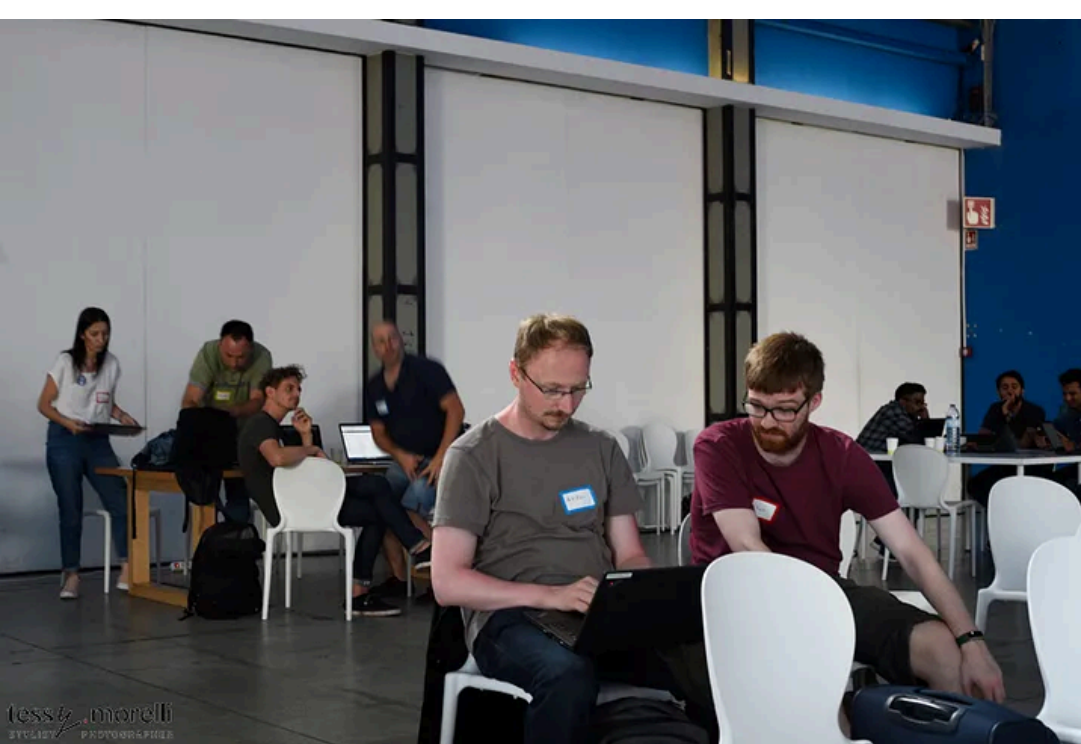
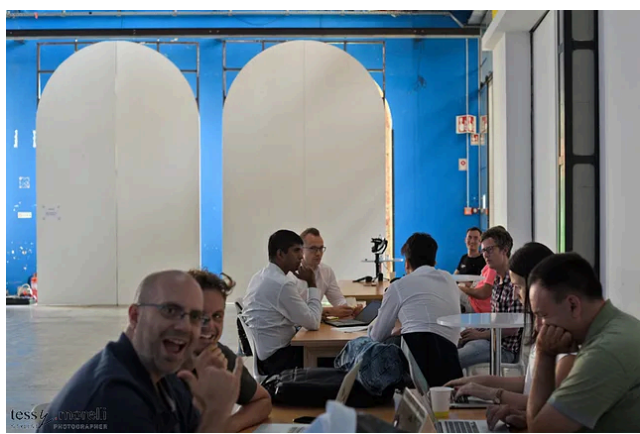
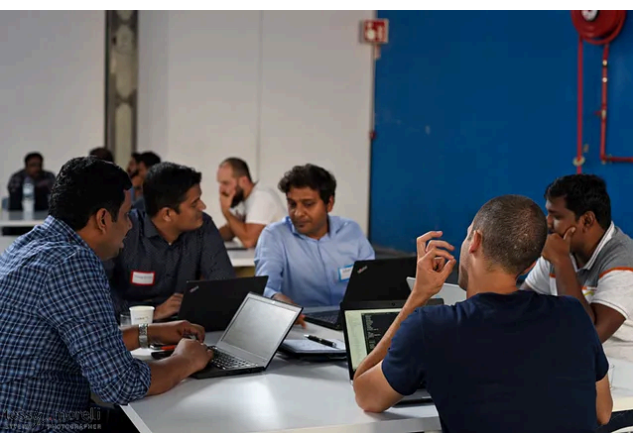
We need an app like this, so in the upcoming weeks we will decide if we can use it as-is or if we will adapt it to make it more consistent with the rest of our tools both visually and technologically.

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That is some impressive work from all the teams for a 24 hour sprint. Thank you for participating! I hope you enjoyed the hackathon as much as our team did, and I believe we will see each other next time!

Meanwhile, please enjoy the photos — courtesy of our amazing photographer Tessy Morelli ([Instagram](#) | [Facebook](#))





Huge thank you to our amazing sponsor — [Etihad Airways!](#)



Choose Well.

Thank you for participating! I hope you enjoyed the hackathon as much as I did, and I believe we will see each other next time!

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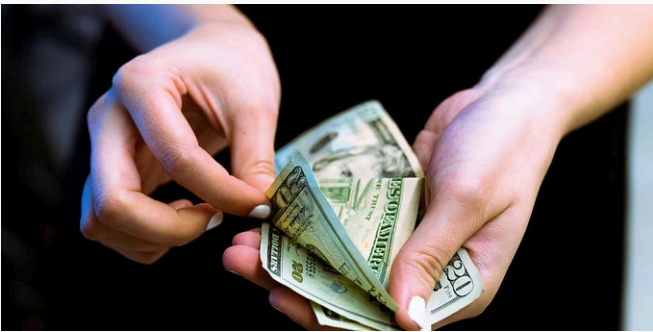
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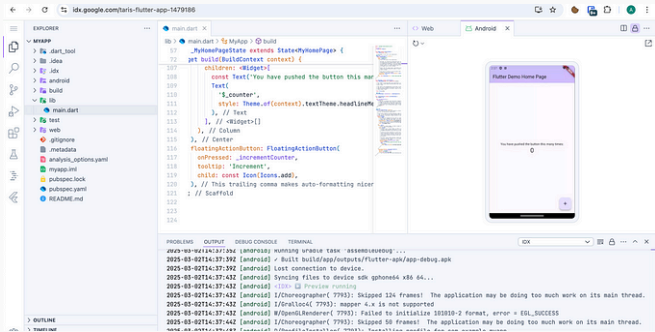
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